

Midrib ➤ Running along the center of the leaf, this thickened area contains the central vein. It also provides support to the leaf to prevent it from bending and breaking.

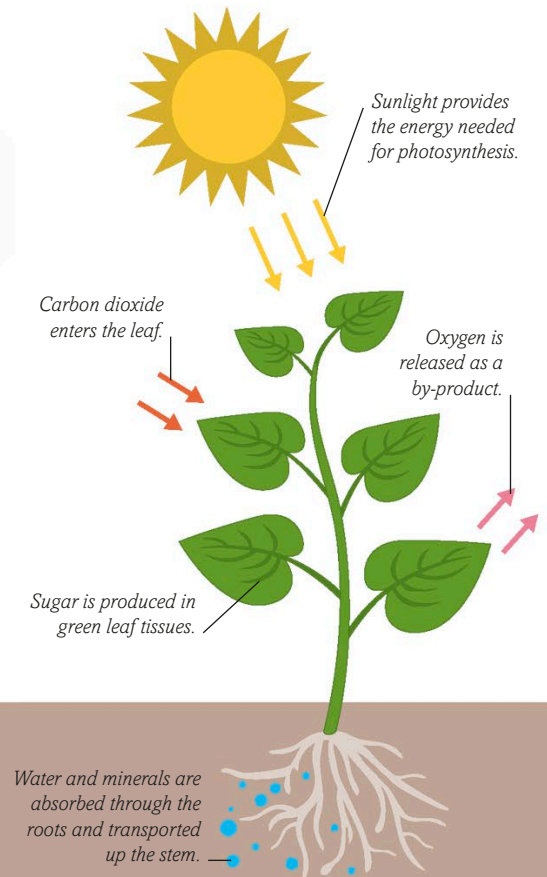


Apple leaf

Vein ➤ Plant veins have two types of tubes running through them. One type, called xylem, carries water from the roots to the shoots. The other type, known as phloem, transports sugars around the plant.

Photosynthesis

Plants make their own food in a process called photosynthesis. Their leaves contain a light-harvesting pigment called chlorophyll. This green chemical uses the sun's energy to convert carbon dioxide from the air and water from the soil into food (in the form of sugars) and oxygen.



Fall leaves

As fall approaches, the green pigment chlorophyll is replaced at a slower rate than it is used up. The reduced chlorophyll levels mean other leaf pigments, including orange-yellow ones, become more obvious. At the same time, plants start producing red-purple pigments. These changes result in the beautiful fall displays of leaf colors.



Maple leaves in fall